

its normal pointing towards the view. Add a material to it, switch to “Node Editor” and replace the “Diffuse BSDF” material with an Emission material. Leave the emission colour to white. Render the scene again.

Most of the shadows are now gone, but it is still not perfect. With lights, there is no single best preset option. You can always get a better lit scene by tweaking the position or property of some lights. This is why it takes a lot of time and patience to get good at creating well lit scenes. But a certain optimum can be reached with a reasonable amount of practice. Try playing around with lights changing their positions and type. This will give you a better idea about when to use a point light compared to a directional light and also how to set their intensities. Directional Lights can create more uniformly lit scenes but then point lights can illuminate dark spots where directional light is unable to reach.

In theory, a well lit subject requires three spot lights, and no directional light. A main light to capture the most essential details, then a fill light to illuminate the shadows cast by the main light, and a backlight to highlight the edges of the model. For indoor and outdoor scenes, a directional light sets the mood or tone, and additional lights can be placed as per requirement. For new artists, there is a tendency to keep adding many lights to a scene, this is not strictly necessary. Lighting is demanding on the system resources, and the more lights there are, the longer it takes for a scene to render. It is better to try and find a way to get the desired effect, using as few lights as possible. Unless it is an architectural scene where there are multiple lights represented, about four lights are good enough to light up any scene. The flip side of a light, is the shadow, and Blender allows you to tweak various aspects of the shadow as well. You can choose between soft and hard shadows, and tweak the size of the shadows as well. For some scenes, it is possible to create lights that do not cast shadows at all. This option is available as a check box under “Area”. Another trick for effective lighting is to use colour effects. Try this experiment on any 3D object - create a blue spotlight to highlight the main parts of the image. Then, fill in the details with a pink light. Finally, position a green light at the back of the image, making sure that only the edges of the model are lit up. You can play around with the intensities and the positioning of these lights. Colour adds mood to a scene, and conveys emotion. Another option that Blender allows you to do, but one that is not used by many professionals, is to add textures to the lights themselves.